EU unveils major overhaul of consumer rules

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By Eliza Gkritsi · Nov 11, 2026, 11:51 AM · View in your browser

The Commission put forward its highly anticipated revamp of EU consumer rules on Wednesday, with new obligations to regulate deceptive design, influencers and video games, as well as new enforcement powers for Brussels.

It's the "most significant update of EU consumer protection law for over 20 years," Commissioner Michael McGrath told reporters.

The new rules apply to all businesses that offer services or products to European consumers, but will have to be negotiated with the European Parliament and capitals.

A crucial part of the revamp , called the Digital Fairness Act (DFA), will ban so-called "dark patterns," the deceptive and manipulative practices that change consumers' economic behavior. It also outlaws personalized advertising and pricing to minors, as POLITICO reported earlier.

The DFA bans video-game features from being offered to minors, including pay-to-win and other mechanisms that encourage players to spend money to advance in the games. The new rulebook will require businesses to make cancelling subscriptions easier and bring transparency obligations to online influencers and dynamic pricing.

Breaches of the rules can be investigated by the European Commission, instead of national authorities, if they have the potential to affect two-thirds of European countries and people, as POLITICO reported earlier. The Commission can levy fines up to 6% of a company's annual global revenue.

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